

SCHOOLS OF BUDDHISM

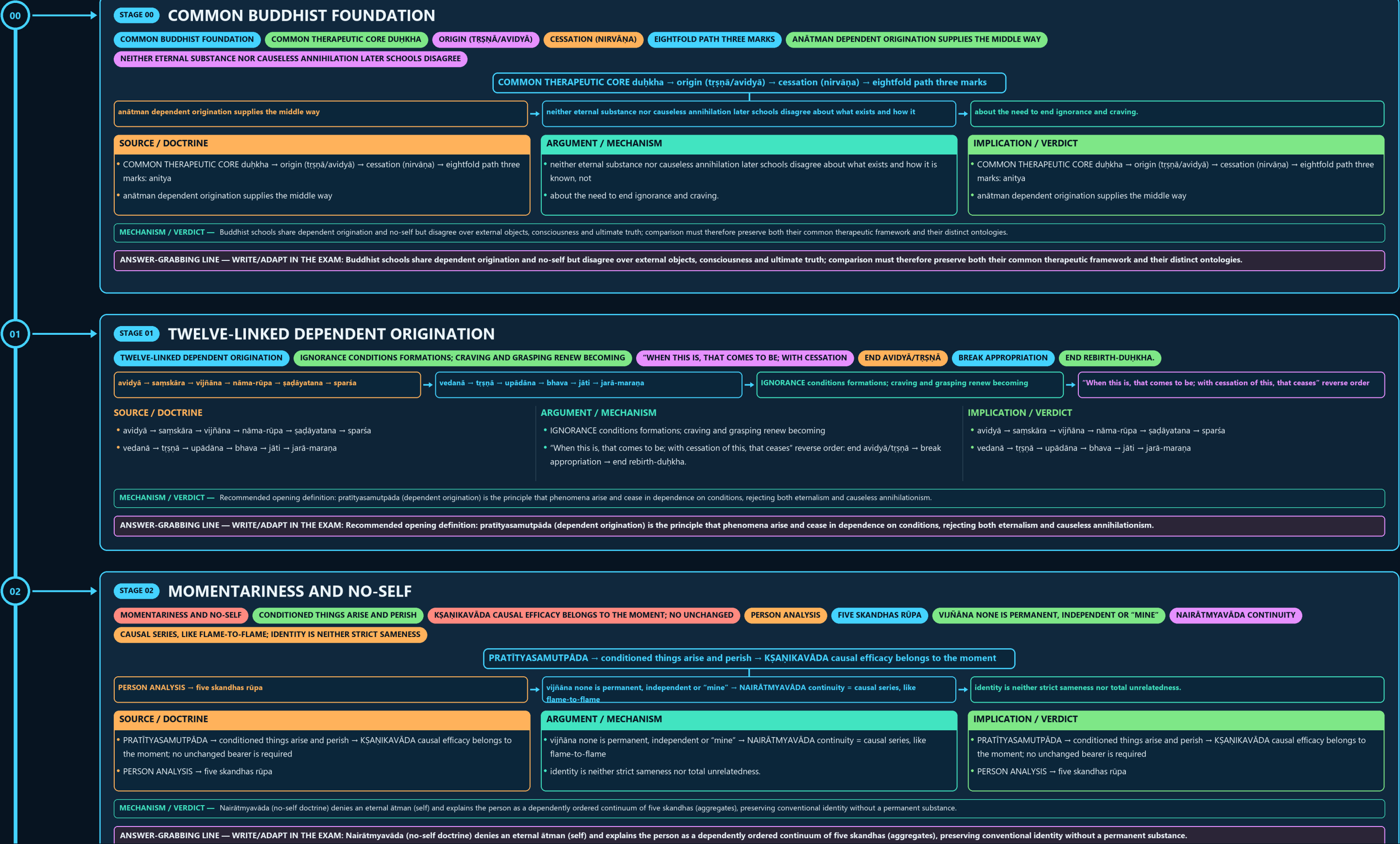
COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION → TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION → MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF → KARMA, MEMORY AND NIRVĀṆA – ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK → VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



vedanā → tr̥ṣṇā → upādāna → bhava → jāti → jarā-maraṇa

• "When this is, that comes to be; with cessation of this, that ceases" reverse order: end avidyā/tr̥ṣṇā → break appropriation → end rebirth-duḥkha.

vedanā → tr̥ṣṇā → upādāna → bhava → jāti → jarā-maraṇa

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: prātīyasamutpāda (dependent origination) is the principle that phenomena arise and cease in dependence on conditions, rejecting both eternalism and causeless annihilationism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: prātīyasamutpāda (dependent origination) is the principle that phenomena arise and cease in dependence on conditions, rejecting both eternalism and causeless annihilationism.

02

STAGE 02

MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF

MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF

CONDITIONED THINGS ARISE AND PERISH

KṢANIKAVĀDA CAUSAL EFFICACY BELONGS TO THE MOMENT; NO UNCHANGED

PERSON ANALYSIS

FIVE SKANDHAS RŪPA

VIJÑĀNA NONE IS PERMANENT, INDEPENDENT OR "MINE"

NAIRĀTMYAVĀDA CONTINUITY

CAUSAL SERIES, LIKE FLAME-TO-FLAME; IDENTITY IS NEITHER STRICT SAMENESS

PRATĪYASAMUTPĀDA → conditioned things arise and perish → KṢANIKAVĀDA causal efficacy belongs to the moment

PERSON ANALYSIS → five skandhas rūpa

→ vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NAIRĀTMYAVĀDA continuity = causal series, like flame-to-flame

→ identity is neither strict sameness nor total unrelatedness.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• PRATĪYASAMUTPĀDA → conditioned things arise and perish → KṢANIKAVĀDA causal efficacy belongs to the moment; no unchanged bearer is required

• PERSON ANALYSIS → five skandhas rūpa

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• vijñāna none is permanent, independent or "mine" → NAIRĀTMYAVĀDA continuity = causal series, like flame-to-flame

• identity is neither strict sameness nor total unrelatedness.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• PRATĪYASAMUTPĀDA → conditioned things arise and perish → KṢANIKAVĀDA causal efficacy belongs to the moment; no unchanged bearer is required

• PERSON ANALYSIS → five skandhas rūpa

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Nairātmyavāda (no-self doctrine) denies an eternal ātman (self) and explains the person as a dependently ordered continuum of five skandhas (aggregates), preserving conventional identity without a permanent substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nairātmyavāda (no-self doctrine) denies an eternal ātman (self) and explains the person as a dependently ordered continuum of five skandhas (aggregates), preserving conventional identity without a permanent substance.

03

STAGE 03

KARMA, MEMORY AND NIRVĀṆA

KARMA, MEMORY AND NIRVĀṆA

NO ĀTMAN, YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY INTENTION AT T1

CONDITIONS STREAM

FRUIT AT T2 MEMORY

LATER COGNITION CAUSALLY CONDITIONED BY EARLIER EXPERIENCE REBIRTH

ONE PSYCHO-PHYSICAL SERIES CONDITIONS ANOTHER, WITHOUT SOUL-TRANSMIGRATION OBJECTION

IF AGENT PERISHES, ANOTHER RECEIVES RESULT REPLY

SUCCESSOR IS NEITHER IDENTICAL NOR WHOLLY DIFFERENT; CAUSAL APPROPRIATION

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• NO ĀTMAN, YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later

• causal appropriation connects nirvāṇa = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• NO ĀTMAN, YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later

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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — NO ĀTMAN, YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later cognition causally conditioned by earlier experience rebirth = one psycho-physical series conditions another, without soul-transmigration objection: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects nirvāṇa = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects nirvāṇa = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

04

STAGE 04

ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

BUDDHIST REALITY

KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

HĪNAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA YOGĀCĀRA MĀDHYAMIKA EXTERNAL EXTERNAL OBJECTS COGNITION EMPTINESS

SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO

HĪNAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

→

BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

→

and causal effects perceived

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

• HĪNAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred from ideas only

• and causal effects perceived

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.

• BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The four-school debate moves from Vaibhāṣika (Abhidharma realist school) and Sautrāntika (Sūtra-based representationalist school) to Yogācāra (yoga-practice consciousness-centred school) and Mādhyamika (Middle Way emptiness school), progressively questioning what can count as ultimately real.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The four-school debate moves from Vaibhāṣika (Abhidharma realist school) and Sautrāntika (Sūtra-based representationalist school) to Yogācāra (yoga-practice consciousness-centred school) and Mādhyamika (Middle Way emptiness school), progressively questioning what can count as ultimately real.

SCHOOLS OF BUDDHISM • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 1957-5191 of 9106 • continues below

MECHANISM / VERDICT — NO ATMAN, YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later cognition causally conditioned by earlier experience rebirth = one psycho-physical series conditions another, without soul-transmigration objection: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects nirvāṇa = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

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04

STAGE 04 ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK **BUDDHIST REALITY** **KNOWLEDGE DEBATE** **HĪNAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA** **VAIBHĀŚIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA YOGĀCĀRA MĀDHYAMIKA EXTERNAL EXTERNAL OBJECTS COGNITION EMPTINESS** **SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO**

BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

HĪNAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA

→ Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred from ideas only

→ and causal effects perceived

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- **BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE**
- **HĪNAYĀNA REALISTS MAHĀYĀNA**

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred from ideas only all svabhāva directly
- and causal effects perceived

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- **SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.**
- **BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE**

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The four-school debate moves from Vaibhāṣika (Abhidharma realist school) and Sautrāntika (Sūtra-based representationalist school) to Yogācāra (yoga-practice consciousness-centred school) and Mādhyamika (Middle Way emptiness school), progressively questioning what can count as ultimately real.

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05

STAGE 05 VAIBHĀŚIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA

VAIBHĀŚIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA **ISSUE VAIBHĀŚIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA EXTERNAL OBJECT REAL DHARMAS REAL MOMENTARY** **DHARMAS EXIST ONLY PRESENT CAUSAL MOMENT STRESSED COGNITION GRASPS** **SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT** **OBJECT-MOMENT IS GONE WHEN AWARENESS OCCURS**
THEREFORE COGNITION PRESENTS AN IMAGE, FROM WHICH EXTERNAL CAUSE **REPRESENTATIVE REALISM MUST EXPLAIN CORRESPONDENCE.**

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ISSUE VAIBHĀŚIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future
sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs

therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

EVALUATION / TRAP

PRESSURE: representative realism must explain correspondence.

ISSUE VAIBHĀŚIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- **ISSUE VAIBHĀŚIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA** external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future
- sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- **SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT:** object-moment is gone when awareness occurs
- therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

EVALUATION / TRAP

- **PRESSURE:** representative realism must explain correspondence.
- **ISSUE VAIBHĀŚIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA** external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

MECHANISM / VERDICT — therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

06

STAGE 06 YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA

YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA **VIJÑĀNAVĀDA MĀDHYAMIKA** **ŚŪNYAVĀDA SUBJECT-OBJECT DUALITY IS CONSTRUCTED ALL THINGS LACK SVABHĀVA** **REPRESENTATION-ONLY DEPENDENT ARISING** **EMPTINESS ĀLAYA-VIJÑĀNA STORES BĪJA TENDENCIES TWO TRUTHS** **PARAMĀRTHA THREE NATURES**
PARIKALPITA, TETRALEMMA REJECTS IS **IS-NOT PARATANTRA, PARINIṢPANNA BOTH**

YOGĀCĀRA / VIJÑĀNAVĀDA MĀDHYAMIKA / ŚŪNYAVĀDA subject-object duality is constructed all things lack svabhāva vijñapti-mātra

→ = emptiness ālaya-vijñāna stores bīja tendencies two truths: saṃvṛti / paramārtha three natures: parikalpita, tetralemma

→ is-not paratantra, pariniṣpanna both / neither as ultimate capture

→ **CONVERGENCE:** dissolve reification

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- **YOGĀCĀRA / VIJÑĀNAVĀDA MĀDHYAMIKA / ŚŪNYAVĀDA** subject-object duality is constructed all things lack svabhāva vijñapti-mātra: representation-only dependent arising
- = emptiness ālaya-vijñāna stores bīja tendencies two truths: saṃvṛti / paramārtha three natures: parikalpita, tetralemma rejects is /

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- is-not paratantra, pariniṣpanna both / neither as ultimate capture
- **CONVERGENCE:** dissolve reification

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- **DIFFERENCE:** Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyamika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.
- **YOGĀCĀRA / VIJÑĀNAVĀDA MĀDHYAMIKA / ŚŪNYAVĀDA** subject-object duality is constructed all things lack svabhāva vijñapti-mātra: representation-only dependent arising

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Kṣāṇikavāda (doctrine of momentariness) holds that whatever is causally efficient exists only momentarily, because a permanent entity could neither change its causal power nor produce genuinely successive effects.

perception inferred from mental image past/future

- sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object

- therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

- ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental image past/future

MECHANISM / VERDICT — therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

06

STAGE 06

YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA

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PARIKALPITA, TETRALEMMA REJECTS IS IS-NOT PARATANTRA, PARINIṢPANNA BOTH

YOGĀCĀRA / VIJÑĀNAVĀDA MĀDHYAMIKA / ŚŪNYAVĀDA subject-object duality is constructed all things lack svabhāva vijñapti-mātra

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ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- is-not paratantra, pariniṣpanna both / neither as ultimate capture
- CONVERGENCE: dissolve reification

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DIFFERENCE: Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyamika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.
- YOGĀCĀRA / VIJÑĀNAVĀDA MĀDHYAMIKA / ŚŪNYAVĀDA subject-object duality is constructed all things lack svabhāva vijñapti-mātra: representation-only dependent arising

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Kṣāṇikavāda (doctrine of momentariness) holds that whatever is causally efficient exists only momentarily, because a permanent entity could neither change its causal power nor produce genuinely successive effects.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kṣāṇikavāda (doctrine of momentariness) holds that whatever is causally efficient exists only momentarily, because a permanent entity could neither change its causal power nor produce genuinely successive effects.

07

STAGE 07

CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE

CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE FLUX CANNOT EXPLAIN CONTINUITY ANĀTMAN WEAKENS AGENCY ŚŪNYATĀ IS NIHILISM CAUSAL SERIES DEPENDENT RESPONSIBILITY EMPTINESS DENIES SELF-NATURE, NOT FUNCTION ANSWER RAIL COMMON CORE

OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity

anātman weakens agency

śūnyatā is nihilism

REPLIES: causal series

dependent responsibility

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity
- anātman weakens agency
- śūnyatā is nihilism
- REPLIES: causal series

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- dependent responsibility
- emptiness denies self-nature, not function
- ANSWER RAIL common core → twelve links → momentariness → five-skandha no-self
- karma/memory reply → four-school fork → exact school comparison

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- objection/reply → qualified verdict
- CLOSE: Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process
- its schools progressively debate whether external dharmas, cognition, or any intrinsic nature can be retained.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The central realist criticism is that momentariness and no-self cannot explain recognition, memory and moral responsibility; the Buddhist reply relocates continuity from substance to causally connected santāna (continuum).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The central realist criticism is that momentariness and no-self cannot explain recognition, memory and moral responsibility; the Buddhist reply relocates continuity from substance to causally connected santāna (continuum).

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED DERIVATION AND SCHOOL DIVERGENCE

IT DIAGNOSES THE STRUCTURE OF CONDITIONED BECOMING HERE AND THIS AVOIDS ETERNALISM BECAUSE NO UNCHANGED SELF GROUNDS THE THE DOCTRINE SUPPORTS DIFFERENT ONTOLOGICAL CONCLUSIONS.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced derivation and school divergence Dependent origination is not a search for the universe's first cause.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- It diagnoses the structure of conditioned becoming here and now.
- This avoids eternalism because no unchanged self grounds the process, and avoids annihilationism because causal continuity remains.
- The doctrine supports different ontological conclusions.
- Mādhyamika argues that whatever depends on conditions lacks svabhāva and is therefore empty.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Vaibhāṣika and Sautrāntika instead emphasise that causally functioning conditioned events are real.
- Their disagreement concerns ultimate status, not whether dependent arising occurs.
- The strongest challenge is regress: if every event is conditioned, what explains the chain as a whole?
- The Buddhist reply is therapeutic and structural rather than foundational—the task is to identify and cease the conditions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.